

Daily Current Affairs Notes

1. Sports – Retirement Announcement

- Lionel Messi announced his retirement from international football; a detailed list of his career awards (FIFA World Cup, Copa America, Ballon d'Or etc.) is planned for the next class.

2. UPSC CAPF Result 2026

- UPSC CAPF written (final) result was declared on 25 August 2026.
- Motivational point: a student who cleared the exam after about one year of preparation was highlighted – normal preparation time for such exams is roughly 6–8 months; selection in 3–4 months is exceptional, not the norm.

3. Iran – USA – Jordan Tension & Strait of Hormuz Geography

- Background: The conflict originally began as an Israel–Iran confrontation. The USA entered in support of Israel; subsequently Israel stepped back and the confrontation continued mainly as Iran vs USA.
- Iran fired a ballistic missile at two US airbases located inside **Jordan** (capital: **Amman**); in response the USA carried out a strike on Iran's **Larak Island**.
- Islands of Iran located in the **Strait of Hormuz** (between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman): **Larak Island** (already struck), **Qeshm/Qasam Island** (associated with 'Hara Mangroves'), and **Hengam Island** (not yet struck – a possible future flashpoint).
- A recent 14-point US-proposed peace deal/ceasefire had been signed by Iran before this fresh escalation.
- Related geography (Israel–Jordan–Syria region): Jordan River, Dead Sea (saline lake, between Israel and Jordan), Sea of Galilee, Golan Heights (disputed between Israel and Syria), Petra in Jordan (one of the New 7 Wonders of the World).
- Google Maps now shows the **Gulf of Mexico** as '**Gulf of America**' for US-based searches, reflecting the US government's renaming.

4. World Bank & Quantum Mechanics (Static GK)

- World Bank: created in 1944, began functioning in 1945; headquartered in Washington DC, USA.
- The whole current year is dedicated to Quantum Mechanics/Quantum Science; per the lecture the concept was introduced by a scientist referred to as 'Werner/Vannevar Karl' – name unclear from audio, likely Max Planck or Werner Heisenberg; verify from a standard source.

Quick MCQs (from this section)

- Q1. A collective action problem with two participants is known as? → **Prisoner's Dilemma**
 Q2. World Bank was created in which year and started functioning in which year? → **Created 1944, functional from 1945**
 Q3. Which US-struck island lies in the Strait of Hormuz? → **Larak Island**
 Q4. Iran attacked two US airbases located in which country? → **Jordan**

5. Himachal Pradesh – First Ozone-based Water Purification Plant

- Himachal Pradesh CM: **Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu**.
- India's/Himachal's first ozone-based plant to purify tap/drinking water has been set up at **Dehra, Kangra district**, Himachal Pradesh.
- Total investment: Rs. 46 crore; project falls under the Ministry of **Jal Shakti**, supporting the **Har Ghar Jal** mission (safe, purified drinking water to every household).
- Working principle: oxygen is passed through a high-voltage electrical process; oxygen molecules combine to form ozone (O₃), which removes bacteria and other contaminants from water, making it purified/potable.
- Ozone in the atmosphere: found in the **Ozonosphere**, located within the **Stratosphere** layer of the atmosphere.
- On 2 October, the HP government also plans to launch a scheme offering 300 units of free electricity.

6. Awards & International Recognition

- Ukraine's President **Zelenskyy** conferred the '**Order of Freedom**' award on **Elon Musk** (on 26 August 2026) for providing Starlink internet connectivity services to Ukraine during the Russia–Ukraine war (ongoing since 2022).
- Elon Musk's key ventures: SpaceX, Tesla, and the Starlink project (satellite internet connectivity); Starlink is also being provided free of cost in Nepal.
- The **FIFA Peace Prize** was awarded to **Donald Trump**.
- PM Narendra Modi has received a total of **36 global awards** so far.
- Ukraine: capital – **Kyiv** (continent: Europe); major river – **Dnipro/Nipiro**; neighbours – Belarus, Russia; borders the Black Sea; **Crimea** lies to its south.

7. Governance / Polity & Static Facts

- Government of Arunachal Pradesh follows a **Unicameral system** – it has only a Legislative Assembly (Vidhan Sabha) and no Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad); it does have a legislature.
- National Consumer Day**: 24 December. **World Consumer Rights Day**: 15 March.
- 'Average income' of a country is technically termed **Per Capita Income**, which is used to calculate National Income.
- Autotrophs** (green plants) obtain the carbon and energy they require through the process of **Photosynthesis**.
- A 'mascular' (muscular) organ example commonly asked in exams: the **Heart**.
- Purpose of **Quantitative Research**: to generate/collect **numerical data** (as opposed to qualitative, descriptive data).

Quick MCQs (from this section)

- Q5. Where was Himachal Pradesh's first ozone-based water purification plant set up? → **Dehra, Kangra district**

- Q6. Which award did Elon Musk receive from Ukraine, and why? → **Order of Freedom, for Starlink services**
Q7. Who received the FIFA Peace Prize? → **Donald Trump**
Q8. How many global awards has PM Modi received so far? → **36**
Q9. Government of Arunachal Pradesh follows which legislative system? → **Unicameral**
Q10. National Consumer Day is observed on? → **24 December**

8. India – Kuwait Relations

- India and Kuwait held their **first Joint Defence Committee meeting** in **New Delhi** on **28 August 2026**, covering cooperation across Army, Air Force, Navy and DRDO.
- Notably, Kuwait had signed a similar defence agreement with **Pakistan** just one day earlier, on **27 August 2026**.
- PM Modi had earlier visited Kuwait in **2024**.
- Kuwait: capital – **Kuwait City**; located in the Middle East; shares its border with **Iraq** and **Saudi Arabia**; also borders the **Persian Gulf**.
- Kuwait is a member of both the **GCC** (Gulf Cooperation Council) and **OPEC**; known for crude oil and natural gas reserves; has no perennial (natural) river or lake.

9. Norway – Change of Monarch

- Norway's King (referred to in the lecture as **King Haakon VIII**) has passed away; his son, the former **Crown Prince Haakon** (age 53), has now become the new King.
- The new King's wife, **Mette-Marit**, becomes Queen.
- Norway: capital – **Oslo** (city where the Nobel Peace Prize is presented each year); located in Europe; has a King, a Prime Minister and a President-type structure co-existing.
- Norway is part of the **Nordic/Scandinavian** group of countries – Norway, Sweden, Finland, Denmark form the core group; adding Iceland makes the wider 5-nation **Nordic** group.

10. Uganda – Death of Youngest King

- Uganda (located in Africa) – its king, **Oyo Nyimba**, who was recognised as the world's youngest reigning king, has passed away at the age of **34**.
- He had been appointed/crowned king at the age of just **3 years**.

11. Foreign Visits (Brief Mentions)

- PM Modi participated in the **Nomadic Games** in Kyrgyzstan.
- India's **International Kite Festival** welcomed a special guest, **Friedrich Merz** (from Germany).

Quick MCQs (from this section)

- Q11. Where was the first India–Kuwait Joint Defence Committee meeting held? → **New Delhi**
Q12. Kuwait is a member of which two organisations mentioned in class? → **GCC and OPEC**
Q13. Who became the new King of Norway after his father's death? → **Crown Prince Haakon**
Q14. Capital of Norway (venue of the Nobel Peace Prize)? → **Oslo**
Q15. Which African country's youngest-ever king passed away at age 34? → **Uganda (King Oyo Nyimba)**

12. Neelakurinji (Blue-Violet) Flower

- Neelakurinji is a bluish-purple flower that traditionally blooms once every **12 years**, though the last bloom before this one occurred after a gap of 16 years.
- This year's bloom is unusually sparse and **scattered** compared to previous cycles.
- Found in the **Nilgiri Hills**, spread across **Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu**, within the **Western Ghats**.
- This year it has bloomed at **Kudremukh National Park**, near **Chikmagalur**, Karnataka.
- Western Ghats: recognised as a UNESCO **biodiversity hotspot** and also known for its **Biosphere Reserve** status.
- IUCN status of the flower: falls under the **'Threatened'** category (a broader category that includes Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered).
- Numbers have been declining since 2022; the Nilgiri Hills are called the **'Blue Mountains'** because of the blue colour these flowers give the hills when in bloom.
- Protected locally by the **Paliyan tribe** (also associated: the **Toda tribe** of Tamil Nadu, where the Western and Eastern Ghats meet).
- Local Kerala name for the flower: **'Kaala Poo'**. Associated grassland/forest ecosystem: **Shola forest/grassland**. The Nilgiri Hills region contains five national parks, including **Bandipur National Park**.

13. Arunachal Pradesh – Rivers & Schemes

- The **Siang River** enters Arunachal Pradesh from the **Upper Siang district**; it is the same river known elsewhere as the **Brahmaputra**.
- The **CM Arogya Arunachal Yojana** (health scheme) was launched in the year **2018**.

14. Bihar – Jharkhand: Son River Water-Sharing Agreement (2026)

- Bihar was formed on 2 March 1912 (as a province); Jharkhand was carved out of Bihar and formed on 15 November 2000.
- The **Son River** is a south-to-north flowing tributary of the **Ganga** – one of the few rivers in India that flows in this direction.
- The Son River passes through Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, with some part of its water also reaching Uttar Pradesh; total length: **784 km**.
- Its own tributaries include the **Rihand River** (water shared by UP and MP) and the **North Koel** (flows through Chhattisgarh).

- Old agreement – the **Ban Sagar Agreement (1973)** – was signed between Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh for sharing Son River water; overseen under the Central Water Commission / Eastern Zonal Council.
- A new agreement (2026) has now been signed between **Bihar and Jharkhand** to share Son River water: Bihar will get approximately **5.75 million acre-feet** and Jharkhand will get approximately **2.0 million acre-feet** of water.

15. Corporate Leadership Changes

- **Apple Inc.** (formed in 1976, USA): CEO **Tim Cook** (in office since 2011, completing a 15-year tenure) stepped down effective **31 August 2026**.
- New Apple CEO, effective **1 September 2026**: **John Ternus**. iPhone 18 is expected to launch around Apple's founding-anniversary date, 9 September.
- **HDFC Bank** Chairperson **Sashidhar Jagdishan** announced his resignation, effective **26 October**, and stated he will not seek re-appointment thereafter.

16. Book Launch

- Rajya Sabha MP **Ghanshyam Tiwari**'s newly authored book was launched by the **Vice President of India**.

Compiled from today's live current-affairs class recording. Names/spellings marked 'unclear from audio' should be re-verified from a standard source before final revision.

All MCQs – Current Affairs Class (Consolidated)

#	Question	Answer	Pg
1	A collective action problem with two participants is known as?	Prisoner's Dilemma	1
2	World Bank was created in which year, and started functioning from which year?	Created 1944; functional from 1945 (HQ: Washington DC)	1
3	Which Iranian island (in the Strait of Hormuz) did the USA strike?	Larak Island	1
4	Iran attacked two US airbases located in which country?	Jordan	1
5	Where was Himachal Pradesh's first ozone-based water purification plant set up?	Dehra, Kangra district	2
6	Which award did Elon Musk receive from Ukraine, and for what reason?	'Order of Freedom' award, for Starlink internet services to Ukraine	2
7	Who received the FIFA Peace Prize?	Donald Trump	2
8	How many global awards has PM Modi received so far (as stated in class)?	36	2
9	The Government of Arunachal Pradesh follows which legislative system?	Unicameral (only Legislative Assembly, no Legislative Council)	2
10	National Consumer Day is observed on which date?	24 December	2
11	World Consumer Rights Day is observed on which date?	15 March	2
12	'Average income' of a country is technically known as?	Per Capita Income	2
13	Autotrophs obtain carbon and energy required for growth through which process?	Photosynthesis	2
14	Give an example of a 'mascular' (muscular) organ.	Heart	2
15	What is the main purpose of Quantitative Research?	To generate numerical data	2
16	Where was the first India–Kuwait Joint Defence Committee meeting held?	New Delhi, on 28 August 2026	3
17	Kuwait is a member of which two international organisations (as discussed in class)?	GCC and OPEC	3
18	Who became the new King of Norway after his father's death?	Crown Prince Haakon (age 53)	3
19	Capital of Norway, also the city where the Nobel Peace Prize is presented?	Oslo	3
20	Which African country's youngest-ever king passed away at age 34?	Uganda (King Oyo Nyimba, crowned at age 3)	3
21	Which river enters Arunachal Pradesh from the Upper Siang district?	Siang River (Brahmaputra)	4
22	The CM Arogya Arunachal Yojana was launched in which year?	2018	4
23	The rare blue-violet Neelakurinji flower has bloomed this year at which location in Karnataka?	Kudremukh National Park, Chikmagalur	4
24	The Son River is a tributary of which major river, and in which unusual direction does it flow?	Tributary of the Ganga; flows south to north	4
25	What is the old (1973) water-sharing agreement for the Son River called, and among which states?	Ban Sagar Agreement; among Bihar, UP and MP	4
26	Under the new 2026 agreement, how much Son River water is allotted to Bihar and Jharkhand?	Bihar: ~5.75 million acre-feet; Jharkhand: ~2.0 million acre-feet	4
27	Who is the outgoing CEO of Apple, and who is the incoming CEO?	Outgoing: Tim Cook; Incoming: John Ternus	4

#	Question	Answer	Pg
28	Who resigned as Chairperson of HDFC Bank, effective 26 October?	Sashidhar Jagdishan	4